MICHELLE GONZÁLEZ AMADOR

Development Economist; Wageningen University & Research

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Computational Economics; Development Economics; Economics of Education; Social and Economic Networks; Human Capital; Field & Lab-in-the-Field Experiments; Machine Learning for Public Policy

EMPLOYMENT

- **Wageningen University & Research**; Postdoctoral Researcher 2026–present
  Information Technology Group (0.2 FTE, since 1 November 2026)
  Contributing to the development of AIM for Scale's *AI for Agriculture* innovation package for low- and middle-income countries, as part of an international research collaboration
- **Wageningen University & Research**; Postdoctoral Researcher 2024–2027
  Agricultural Economics and Rural Policy Group (AEP; currently 0.8 FTE): Education, human capital investment, inequality in LMICs
- **UNU-MERIT & Maastricht University**; Research Consultant 2023–2024
  Innovations for Policy Analysis: machine learning, experimentalism
- **International Labour Organization**; Consultant 2018–2019
  Research and monitoring strategy: Youth Aspirations and the Future of Work
- **World Bank Group**, Education Global Practice; Consultant 2016–2017
  Quantitative research, monitoring, inter-agency collaboration: University Governance Score Card
- **OECD** Development Centre, EMEA Desk; **UNECE** Population Unit; Intern 2012; 2014
  Research: African Economic Outlook 2012; Chapter 8 of *Mainstreaming Ageing in Georgia* (UNECE)

EDUCATION

- **UNU-MERIT & Maastricht University School of Business and Economics**; PhD 2016–2024
  PhD in Innovation, Economics and Governance for Development; Promotor: Robin Cowan
  Dissertation: *Learning in Low and Middle-Income Countries: Essays on Education and Development Economics*
- **Stanford University**; Visiting Researcher Summer 2024
  Stanford Impact Labs, Equitable Access to Education Lab: design of evaluation and analysis strategy; Advisor: Irene Lo
- **Hertie School of Governance**, Germany; Master of Public Policy 2013–2015
  Concentration in Policy Analysis and Economic Development; Advisor: Mark Hallerberg
- **Sciences Po Rennes**, France; Certificat d'Études Politiques 2010–2011
- **Tec de Monterrey**, Mexico; Bachelor of International Affairs 2008–2013

PUBLICATIONS

- **Welfare-Maximizing Pooled Testing**
  S. Finster, **M. González Amador**, E. Lock, F. Marmolejo-Cossío, E. Micha, and A.D. Procaccia
  Proceedings of the 24th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC'23); 2023; arXiv:2206.10660
  Exemplary Track Paper Award, Applied Modeling; Journal version submitted; Pre-registration: AEA RCT Registry 9466-2.0

- **Youth Aspirations and the Future of Work**
  D. Gardiner, M. Goedhuys, and **M. González Amador**
  Book chapter in *Is the Future Ready for Youth?* ILO, Geneva; 2021; PDF

WORKING PAPERS

- **Peer Networks and Malleability of Educational Aspirations**
  M. González Amador, R. Cowan, and E. Nillesen
  Submitted; Earlier version: arXiv:2209.08340
- **Labor Market Returns to Education and Intra-family Educational Inequality: Theory and Experimental Evidence**
  E. Gehrke and **M. González Amador**
  Lab-in-the-field experiment with parents in Mexico; Presented at NED'26; Pre-registration: AEA RCT Registry 17183-1.0
- **IAC: A Framework for Enabling Patient Agency in the Use of AI-Enabled Healthcare**
  C.T. Okolo and **M. González Amador**
  arXiv:2111.04456

ONGOING FIELD EXPERIMENTS

- **Cash Transfers, Training and Savings Groups in Rural Rwanda** (with E. Bulte and C. Uwizeye)
  Cluster-randomised trial in 90 villages: cash only vs. cash + training + VSLA. Baseline completed; first transfers made in 2026.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Technological Progress and Social Mobility: Schooling Choices when Wage Returns to Education Are Convex (with E. Gehrke)
  NWO SSH Open Competition XS-funded research on nearshoring, wage returns and schooling choices in Mexico
- The Income Gradient of Between-Sibling Educational Inequality (with E. Gehrke and T. Miyamoto)
- Networks and Human Capital
- Social Networks in Rwanda: Network Architecture and Village Dynamics (with E. Bulte and C. Uwizeye)
  Village census of trust and support networks: 16,343 households in 90 villages
- Machine Learning and Tax Base in Developing Countries (with R. Vincent)
- Willingness to Donate in an Emergency: From the Global North to the Global South (with S. Finster and E. Lock)
- Educational Resilience in Times of Crisis: State Policies, Aggregate Shocks and Students' Educational Resilience in Peru

GRANTS & AWARDS

- **NWO SSH Open Competition XS**; €49,992; Co-applicant — 2026
  'Technological progress and social mobility: Schooling choices when wage-returns to education are convex'. Dutch Research Council (NWO), file no. 406.XS.26.02.107
- **Exemplary Track Paper Award**, Applied Modeling; EC'23 — 2023
  24th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation, for 'Welfare-Maximizing Pooled Testing'
- **DUS-I International Collaborative Virtual Project Grant**; €15,000; co-PI — 2023–2024
  Machine Learning for Public Policy

RESEARCH SOFTWARE

- **Education Equity Technology** (with E. Lock) 2025
  Offline-first tablet web app (JavaScript, Flask) for enumerator-led surveys and lab-in-the-field experiments, with built-in cluster-level randomisation. Used for a parental allocation task with randomised scenario order in 16 schools in San Luis Potosí, Mexico; Source code
- **C-SEF** (with K. Molinet, S. Finster and E. Lock) 2021–2023
  Web app implementing the welfare-maximizing pooled testing algorithm and running the field experiment described in Finster et al. (EC'23), at IPICYT, Mexico

WEBSITES & OPEN EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES

- ml4publicpolicy.com: Open-source course, Machine Learning for Public Policy since 2022
- dev-econ.nl: Dutch Development Economics Network (DuDe) since 2025
- VIC: Bilingual site for the Verano Internacional de la Ciencia 2026
- curso-ia-slp.com: *Intro a la IA*, online AI course for high-school students in Mexico 2026

TEACHING

- **UNU-MERIT / Maastricht University**; MSc Public Policy and Human Development; Lecturer & Teaching Assistant
  - Machine Learning for Public Policy (course development) 2022–2025
  - Introduction to Data Science and Statistics 2017–2023
  - Econometrics: Regression Analysis I & II 2019–2021
  - Public Policy 2022
  - Public Policy Analysis (Impact Evaluation) 2017–2018
- **SBE, Maastricht University**; BSc Economics and Business Economics; Teaching Assistant
  - Network Economics 2021
- **High-school students, San Luis Potosí, Mexico** (WUR, YouiLab, IPICYT); Course Designer
  - Intro a la IA: 15-session online course, with guest live sessions 2026
- **PhD workshops**
  - Gentle Introduction to R for Network Analysis; UNU-MERIT PhD Program 2019–2020
  - Gentle Introduction to Overleaf and LaTeX; GPAC^2 PhD Program 2022

MSC THESIS SUPERVISION

- **MSc Public Policy & Human Development, UNU-MERIT**
  Sten Ritterfeld, Erin Loutitt, Gabriela Cervantes Valerezo, Jessica van Wijgerden, Bansi Popat, Danila Viano, Giorgos Oikonomides, Juan Pablo Alvarez Vega, Alexandra 'Alessa' Haller, Leopoldo Pérez Obregón, Felix Märtin, Alex Mayiopoulos, Nandini Das

INVITED TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

- Nederlandse Economendag (NED'26), The Hague 2026
  Labor Market Returns to Education and Intra-family Educational Inequality: Theory and Experimental Evidence
- Invited talk, NetSci4SDGs, NetSci 2025 Satellite Symposium, Maastricht 2025
  Network Science for Development: An Overview with a Focus on Quality of Education (SDG4)

- Co-panelist, Winter International School on Research in Communications and Social Sciences – Latin America (WIRSS'21) 2021

CONFERENCE ORGANISATION & ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Co-organiser, EAAMO'25 Local | Oxford 2025
  Satellite of the ACM Conference on Equity and Access in Algorithms, Mechanisms, and Optimization. Linacre College, Oxford: three-day programme with four keynotes and contributed talks; hosted Indigenous researchers from the EAAMO-REDNACECYT Summer of Science
- Panel Organiser, J-PAL and EAAMO: Equity and Inclusion of Emerging Indigenous Scientists and Local Partners 2024
  ACM Conference on Equity and Access in Algorithms, Mechanisms, and Optimization (EAAMO'24), San Luis Potosí
- Program Committee Member, ACM EAAMO (EAAMO'22 & EAAMO'23) 2022–2023
- Co-chair, Diversity and Inclusion: Geographical Inclusion, ACM EAAMO'21 2021
- Working Group Co-organiser, MD4SG – Latin America and Caribbean (MD4SG.com) 2021–2023
- Co-founder & co-organiser, Verano Internacional de la Ciencia (EAAMO-Bridges, with REDNACECYT) since 2020
- Invited participant, ODI international roundtable: AI & Infrastructure, Experimentalism & 4IR 2022
- Seminar Organiser, METECH Seminars for technical skills, UNU-MERIT IEGD PhD Program 2017–2021

MEMBERSHIPS

Association for Computing Machinery (ACM); Network Science Society (NetSci); Dutch Development Economics Network (DuDe); EAAMO-Bridges (project co-organiser)

MEDIA & PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- **Verano Internacional de la Ciencia (Summer of Science)**
  Featured by UNU-MERIT (*Supporting Indigenous Women Researchers to Flourish*); Harvard SEAS (2023); Harvard ReVista (2024); La Jornada San Luis
- **SIGecom Exchanges:** *Welfare-Maximizing Pooled Testing*, Vol. 22(1), 2024
  ACM Special Interest Group on Economics and Computation

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

- **Programming:** R, Python, Julia, Stata, LaTeX, Quarto, Git, JavaScript, HTML & CSS
- **Research & project:** Field survey, project management, inter-agency collaboration, policy brief & report writing, public communication
- **Languages:** Spanish (C2), English (C2), French (B2), German (A2)